

PREMIUM GUIDE

UC BERKELEY

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Berkeley, California

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1. UC Berkeley at a Glance

#10

QS RANKING

1868

FOUNDED

45,000

STUDENTS

1,500+

INDIAN STUDENTS

95%

PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	UC Berkeley
Location	Berkeley, California, USA
Type	Public (Est. 1868)
Acceptance Rate	12%
Student-Faculty Ratio	18:1
Graduation Rate	93%
International Students	17%
Gender Ratio	52:48 (F:M)
Website	berkeley.edu
Motto	Public Ivy #1 — Birthplace of the Free Speech Movement

UC Berkeley is the top public university in the world and the birthplace of the Free Speech Movement. Known for its CS and Engineering programs, Berkeley is a feeder school for Silicon Valley's top companies.

Notable Alumni

Steve Wozniak — Co-founder of Apple

Eric Schmidt — Former CEO of Google

2. Why Choose UC?

- QS #10 — world's #1 public university
- Berkeley CS is ranked #1 among public universities
- 55 new Indian enrollments annually
- Located 30 minutes from San Francisco and Silicon Valley
- Public university price with Ivy League outcomes
- Birthplace of the Free Speech Movement and open-source software

| Academic Environment

Intellectually intense and socially conscious. Berkeley students are passionate about both academics and activism. The CS program is world-class. Research is cutting-edge. The public university ethos means accessibility and diversity.

| Student Life

Berkeley is a college town with a radical history. The social scene is diverse — from hackathons to protests to poetry readings. San Francisco is 20 minutes away. The Indian community is large and active.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MS in Computer Science	PG	2 Years	\$28K-32K/yr (in-state: \$15K)	AI, systems, theory, and graphics. One of the world's most competitive CS programs.
MS in Electrical Engineering & Computer Sciences	PG	2 Years	\$28K-32K/yr	The EECS department at Berkeley is ranked #1 globally.
MBA (Haas)	PG	2 Years	\$65K-68K/yr	Top 10 MBA with tech and social impact focus.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	8.0+ (First Class)
GRE	320+
IELTS	7.0+
TOEFL	100+
Work Experience	3+ years (MBA)
LORs	3 LORs
SOP	Required
Resume	Required
Interview	MBA only
Application Fee	\$140

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Aug)	Dec 1	Mar 1

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	\$28,000-32,000/yr
Accommodation	\$15,000-24,000/yr
Food	\$4,000-6,000/yr
Transport	\$1,500/yr
Health Insurance	\$3,500/yr
Personal	\$4,000-6,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Berkeley Graduate Fellowship	\$5,000-15,000/yr	Merit-based	Dec 1
Haas Fellowship	Up to \$40,000	MBA students with social impact focus	Jan 5

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

95% PLACEMENT RATE	\$140,000 AVG SALARY	\$300,000 HIGHEST SALARY	1,000+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	Berkeley India Group — 400+ members
Accommodation	On-campus housing + Berkeley apartments
Avg Rent	\$1,200-2,000/month
Indian Food	Vik's Chaat Corner (Berkeley institution), Udupi Palace, Indian groceries on University Ave
Weather	Mediterranean — mild year-round (10-25°C). Foggy mornings.
Transport	BART train to San Francisco (20 min)
Healthcare	University Health Services
Safety	Safe on campus. Be alert in surrounding areas.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Telegraph Avenue for bars. San Francisco for clubs. House parties in the Berkeley Hills. The social scene is diverse and inclusive.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **Berkeley India Group** — Cultural
- **Bhangra at Berkeley** — Dance
- **CS Mentors** — Tech
- **Berkeley Entrepreneurship** — Entrepreneurship
- **SkyDeck** — Entrepreneurship
- **Berkeley Consulting** — Professional
- **Hiking Club** — Outdoor
- **Film Society** — Creative

11. What Students Say

"Berkeley CS is as good as Stanford's at half the price. I got the same job offers."

— **Aryan**, MS CS '24

"The activism here is real. We code by day and fight for social justice by night."

— **Meera**, MS EECS '25

"SkyDeck helped me launch my startup. Berkeley gives you the tools to change the world."

— **Karan**, MBA Haas '24

Your UC Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your UC Berkeley application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

